



Face-controlled wheelchair

Miyazaki University has made wheelchairs controlled by the expressive muscles in one's face
<http://bit.ly/nzI4Kq>

Criminal use of 3D printers

3D printers are being used to produce ATM skimmers and handcuff keys en masse
<http://bit.ly/mOXoLG>

Q&A

as it will still run slow. A minimum 2 GB of RAM is recommended for Windows 7.

Defective GPU Fan

I'm having a problem with my graphics card (Sparkle NVIDIA GTS 450 GDDR5/1GB) which I bought two months ago. The GPU seems to be working fine but its fan isn't. Sometimes, it starts automatically and sometimes it doesn't. Temperatures reach 100°C at load and 65°C at idle. The vendor from whom I bought this card says that this is due to my current SMPS, so I changed my SMPS from 450 watts to Cooler Master 650 watts, but the problem persists. When I asked him to repair/replace it, he said that it wasn't a big problem and the company wouldn't repair or replace it. Please tell me what I should do to sort out this problem.

My system specs:

- **Processor:** Intel Core i5 2,500k
- **RAM:** Kingston 4GB ddr3 1333 MHz
- **GPU:** Sparkle NVIDIA gts 450
- **SMPS:** Cooler Master 650 watts
- **Speakers:** Intex 5,000 watt pmpo
- **HDD:** Seagate 500 GB

Suraj Singh

There doesn't seem to be a problem with the SMPS. Most likely, the fan connector must be damaged which is causing the fan to behave erratically. You might want to get just the fan connectors checked by someone. Maybe one of the connector wires has become loose and not making proper contact, which is causing the fan to stop working.

Don't go by the vendor's assurance that it isn't a big problem. On idle, 65 degrees is a big problem. Avoid playing any games or subjecting your GPU to such high temperatures as you'll be reducing its life if it's running at those

temperatures. Your system specs are quite up-to-date and it's a decent gaming rig.

Motherboard pains

One day I found that the front USB ports weren't working. I opened the case and tried different plugs. I also tried a spare USB port but couldn't get anything.

I put everything back together and now it won't boot. It'll POST and reach the Windows loading screen, then spends a minute on the moving blue bar. Then it flashes a blue Screen of Death and reboots.

I wonder if my motherboard is dying. I'll give a brief description of the machine and its recent history:

It's about a 4.5-year-old home-built machine with a couple of upgrades to RAM and graphics over time. Now it's an Athlon 64 2800 socket 754 on an MSI K8T Neo with 1.5g ddr 400 Kingston value and an agp NVIDIA 6800gs.

Recently, I was having issues with graphic lag and artifacting when playing *Warhammer* online. So, a friend of mine lent me his old case and power supply. This did the trick for the graphics issues.

But after the transplant, most of the rear ports except onboard sound and ethernet wouldn't work. So I just began using the front ports.

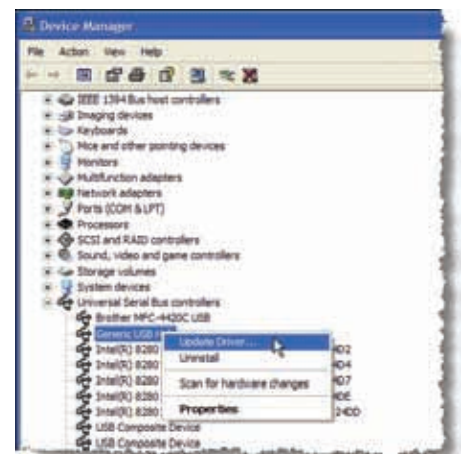
So now I can't boot or connect a mouse or keyboard to my PC. Any ideas? Or do I likely just need a new motherboard?

-via email

Firstly, your system is a bit old, so you can't expect it to perform wonderfully. You'll keep facing issues as components wear out over time. As regards to the USB issue, well, first of all make sure that you have the latest chipset drivers installed. If that's done and USB drives are still not

visible, go to **Device Manager > Universal Serial Bus**. Uninstall all the USB ports. Don't worry, they'll be reinstalled on startup.

If this doesn't work, then disable the USB Selective Suspend by going in the regedit folder. Go to **Run > regedit**. In the regedit folder, try to find this file **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\System\Current\ControlSet\Services\USB**



Update driver using the Device Manager

If the **DisableSelectiveSuspend** registry entry is present then select it and change the value from 0 to 1 to disable it and then click OK. Else create an entry by clicking on **Edit > New > DWORD Type DisableSelectiveSuspend** and press [Enter]. Then on the Edit Menu, click Modify and in the Value field, type 1 to disable the Selective Suspend feature and click OK.

As for the BSOD, you need to clear your CMOS and try rebooting.

If even this doesn't work, then you might have to get your motherboard checked or replaced. It is very possible that your motherboard is having power management issues.

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